Genealogy and Family Names

H 1631

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A. Background

Genealogy is the study of family history and the accounts and records of the ancestry and descent of persons, families, groups, etc. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for cataloging genealogy materials, including works on individual families. For instructions on cataloging local history and genealogical source materials, see H 1845. For instructions on how to establish family names for genealogical resources, see H 1631.5. For instructions on establishing names of noble families, royal houses, dynasties, etc., see H 1574. For classification of genealogical materials, see F 600.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Family histories***. For guidelines on bio-bibliography, see H 1328. For guidelines on biography, see H 1330. For guidelines on diaries, see H 1538. For guidelines on interviews, see H 1678. For guidelines on personal narratives of wars or disasters, see H 1928.

B. Recent revisions

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Genealogy: the study of ancestry, not limited to a particular place, including works on methods of locating and using various types of documents in order to create a family tree or write a family history.

D. The heading Genealogy

Assign the heading ***Genealogy*** to general works on the study of ancestry not limited to a particular place, including works on methods of locating and using various types of documents in order to create a family tree or write a family history.

Do not subdivide this heading by ***--Handbooks, manuals, etc.***, ***--History***, ***--Methodology***, ***--Research***, or ***--Sources***.

E. The subdivision --Genealogy

E.1. General

Assign the free-floating form subdivision ***--Genealogy*** under names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups to works that contain collections of family records and/or histories of families from the place or belonging to the organization, class of persons, or ethnic group.

Do not subdivide headings of this type by ***--History*** or by ***--Sources***.

LC practice: Assign names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups to works that contain collections of family records and/or histories of families from the place or belonging to the organization, class of persons, or ethnic group. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Family histories*** or ***Genealogical tables***.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a African Americans $v Genealogy.
```

LC practice:

650 #0 $a African Americans.

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

651 #0 $a California $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a California.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

651 #0 $a France $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a France.

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a Mexican Americans $z Texas $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Mexican Americans $z Texas.

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a Kings and rulers $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Kings and rulers.

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

651 #0 $a London (England) $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a London (England)

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

610 20 $a United Empire Loyalists $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

610 20 $a United Empire Loyalists.

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

```
655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft
```

E.2. Additional headings

Assign an array of headings to bring out place, ethnic group, class of persons, types of documents, etc. If the work includes names with birth and/or death dates, assign also ***Registers of births, etc.--[place]***. If the work includes more specific types of documents, assign specific headings, for example, ***Marriage records***; ***Death notices***; ***Baptismal records***.

LC practice: Assign an array of headings to bring out place, ethnic group, class of persons, etc. that is the focus of the resource. For guidelines on recording the year of the census, if that is the source of the data, see H 1366. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, including the types of documents, e.g. LCGFT ***Vital statistics*** or ***Death registers***.

Example:

Title: 1850 census of Tazewell County, Virginia, transcribed and indexed for genealogists.

```
651 #0 $a Tazewell County (Va.) $v Genealogy.
650 #0 $a Registers of births, etc. $z Virginia $z Tazewell County.
651 #0 $a Tazewell County (Va.) $v Census, 1850.
651 #0 $a United States $v Census, 1850.
650 #0 $a African Americans $z Virginia $z Tazewell County $v Genealogy.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Tazewell County (Va.) $x Census, 1850.
651 #0 $a United States $x Census, 1850.
650 #0 $a African Americans $z Virginia $z Tazewell County.
655 #7 $a Vital statistics. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Census data. $2 lcgft
```

Title: Marriage and death notices from Wilmington, North Carolina newspapers, 1866-1870.

```
651 #0 $a Wilmington (N.C.) $v Genealogy.
650 #0 $a Marriage records $z North Carolina $z Wilmington.
650 #0 $a Death notices $z North Carolina $z Wilmington.
650 #0 $a American newspapers $z North Carolina $z Wilmington $v Abstracts.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Wilmington (N.C.)
```

```
650 #0 $a American newspapers $z North Carolina $z Wilmington.
655 #7 $a Vital statistics. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Death registers. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Abstracts. $2 lcgft
```

E.3. Methodology

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Genealogy--Methodology*** under names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups for comprehensive texts on methods of locating genealogical records, tracing family histories, etc., in these places, or pertaining to these groups or classes of persons.

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Genealogy--Handbooks, manuals, etc.***, under names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups to works that present brief information about genealogy on these topics, such as lists of agencies and institutions to consult, types of records to study, etc.

For works containing both comprehensive instructions on methodology and brief information for ready reference, assign only ***--Genealogy--Handbooks, manuals, etc.***, under the appropriate heading.

LC practice: Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Genealogy--Methodology*** under names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups for comprehensive texts on methods of locating genealogical records, tracing family histories, etc., in these places, or pertaining to these groups or classes of persons. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Self-instructional works***.

Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Genealogy***, under names of places, individual corporate bodies, classes of persons, and ethnic groups to works that present information about genealogy on these topics, such as lists of agencies and institutions to consult, types of records to study, etc. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Handbooks and manuals***.

For works containing both comprehensive instructions on methodology and brief information for ready reference, assign only the topical subdivision ***--Genealogy***, under the appropriate heading and the LCGFT term ***Handbooks and manuals***.

F. Headings for family names

F.1. General rule

Assign a heading for the name of the family.

Subdivide family names as needed by the free-floating form and topical subdivisions listed in H 1120.

Do not subdivide family names by ***--Biography***, ***--History***, or ***--Sources***.

Optionally, also assign a heading for the authorized access point of the family from the name authority record in the LC/Name Authority File (NAF).

LC practice: Do not subdivide a family name by a form subdivision. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

F.2. Works that discuss more than one family

If more than one family is discussed, assign headings for each family, up to a maximum of four.

F.3. Location of the family

In accordance with H 1845, bring out the location of the family in an additional heading, if possible.

Example:

```
Title: The Cotton family of Northern Virginia.
   600 30 $a Cotton family.
   600 10 $a Cotton, John, $d 1721-1808 $x Family.
   651 #0 $a Virginia, Northern $v Genealogy.
LC practice:
   600 30 $a Cotton family.
   600 10 $a Cotton, John, $d 1721-1808 $x Family.
   651 #0 $a Virginia, Northern.
   655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft
   655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft
```

For countries other than the United States, assign an additional heading of the type ***[country]--Genealogy***.

If the work is a collective biography of the members of a family, do not assign a heading of the type ***[place]--Genealogy***, unless the work also contains genealogical material.

LC practice: For countries other than the United States, assign an additional heading for the place.

Example:

```
Title: Pierssené.
   600 30 $a Pierssené family.
```

650 #0 $a Huguenots $z England $z London $x History.

651 #0 $a London (England) $v Genealogy.

651 #0 $a Great Britain $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Pierssené family.

650 #0 $a Huguenots $z England $z London $x History.

651 #0 $a London (England)

651 #0 $a Great Britain.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

F.4. Progenitors and individual family members

Assign an additional heading for the name of the progenitor, or any individual family member, subdivided by the free-floating subdivision ***--Family*** if he or she is mentioned on the title page or given prominent treatment in the text.

Example:

Title: The Giles Driver family : a compilation of the descendants of Giles Driver, Isle of Wight County, Virginia.

600 30 $a Driver family.

600 10 $a Driver, Giles, $c Sr., $d 1775-1824 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Isle of Wight County (Va.) $v Genealogy.

651 #0 $a Southern States $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Driver family.

600 10 $a Driver, Giles, $c Sr., $d 1775-1824 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Isle of Wight County (Va.)

651 #0 $a Southern States.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

G. Geographic Area codes

For genealogical or biographical works about individual families, assign codes based on the headings selected for the work being cataloged. Do not assign a code for the country in which the family resides unless another heading that includes the name of the country is assigned.

H. Extended examples

Title: Property deeds for genealogy : how to find them.

651 #0 $a United States $x Genealogy $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.

650 #0 $a Deeds $z United States $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a United States $x Genealogy.

650 #0 $a Deeds $z United States.

655 #7 $a Handbook and manuals. $2 lcgft

Title: Hart County, Kentucky, marriage records.

650 #0 $a Marriage records $z Kentucky $z Hart County.

651 #0 $a Hart County (Ky.) $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Marriage records $z Kentucky $z Hart County.

651 #0 $a Hart County (Ky.)

655 #7 $a Vital statistics. $2 lcgft

Title: Tombstone inscriptions of Van Buren County, Tennessee.

651 #0 $a Van Buren County (Tenn.) $v Genealogy.

650 #0 $a Registers of births, etc. $z Tennessee $z Van Buren County.

650 #0 $a Cemeteries $z Tennessee $z Van Buren County.

650 #0 $a Inscriptions $z Tennessee $z Van Buren County.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a Van Buren County (Tenn.)

650 #0 $a Cemeteries $z Tennessee $z Van Buren County.

650 #0 $a Inscriptions $z Tennessee $z Van Buren County.

655 #7 $a Vital statistics. $2 lcgft

Title: Morris, Whittington, Jones, and related families.

600 30 $a Morris family.

600 30 $a Whittington family.

600 30 $a Jones family.

651 #0 $a Southern States $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Morris family.

600 30 $a Whittington family.

600 30 $a Jones family.

651 #0 $a Southern States.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

Title: The ancestry of Amelia Marilla Morley.

600 30 $a Morley family.

600 30 $a Willard family.

600 30 $a Carlton family.

600 30 $a Newton family.

600 10 $a Morley, Amelia Marilla, $d 1842-1927 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Massachusetts $v Genealogy.

651 #0 $a England $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Morley family.

600 30 $a Willard family.

600 30 $a Carlton family.

600 30 $a Newton family.

600 10 $a Morley, Amelia Marilla, $d 1842-1927 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Massachusetts.

651 #0 $a England.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

Title: Joseph Jones of Gates County, North Carolina : his ancestors and descendants.

600 30 $a Jones family.

600 30 $a Jones (Family : $d 1635-1985 : $c Gates County, N.C.)

600 10 $a Jones, Joseph, $d 1851-1930 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Gates County (N.C.) $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Jones family.

600 30 $a Jones (Family : $d 1635-1985 : $c Gates County, N.C.)

600 10 $a Jones, Joseph, $d 1851-1930 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Gates County (N.C.)

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

Title: The Sanchez family of St. Augustine, Florida.

600 30 $a Sanchez family.

600 30 $a Sanchez (Family : $c Saint Augustine, Fla.)

LC practice:

600 30 $a Sanchez family.

600 30 $a Sanchez (Family : $c Saint Augustine, Fla.)

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

Title: The English ancestry of Thomas Jefferson.

600 30 $a Soane family.

600 30 $a Fuller family.

600 30 $a Jefferson family.

600 30 $a Field family.

600 10 $a Jefferson, Thomas, $d 1743-1826 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Virginia $v Genealogy.

LC practice:

600 30 $a Fuller family.

600 30 $a Soane family.

600 30 $a Jefferson family.

600 30 $a Field family.

600 10 $a Jefferson, Thomas, $d 1743-1826 $x Family.

651 #0 $a Virginia.

655 #7 $a Family histories. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Genealogical tables. $2 lcgft

Title: Inscriptions from the tomb stones at Mount Calvary Cemetery.

651 #0 $a Baltimore (Md.) $v Genealogy.

650 #0 $a Registers of births, etc. $z Maryland $z Baltimore.

610 20 $a Mount Calvary Cemetery (Baltimore, Md.)

```
650 #0 $a Inscriptions $z Maryland $z Baltimore.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Baltimore (Md.)
610 20 $a Mount Calvary Cemetery (Baltimore, Md.)
650 #0 $a Inscriptions $z Maryland $z Baltimore.
655 #7 $a Vital statistics. $2 lcgft
```

I. Subdivisions used under individual family names

See H 1120.

Revision history

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.